DECLARATION OF AI ASSISTANCE

Use of Large Language Models in MA Thesis Research

Student Name	Nahian Ibnat
Programme	MA in Economics, Data & Policy
Institution	Central European University
Supervisor	Zoltán Csaba Tóth
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1. Preamble

In accordance with the academic integrity policies of Central European University and the growing institutional expectations around the transparent disclosure of AI tool usage in scholarly work, I hereby declare the nature and extent to which Large Language Models (LLMs) — specifically Claude (Anthropic) — were used in the preparation of my MA thesis titled *"Do Politicians' Words Have a Dollar Value? Measuring the Impact of Climate Policy Sentiment on Sovereign Green Bond Pricing in India and Indonesia."*

This declaration distinguishes clearly between work conducted independently by the student and work in which AI assistance played a supporting role. All intellectual contributions, research design decisions, and substantive scholarly judgements remain entirely my own.

2. Work Conducted Independently by the Student

The following elements of the thesis were carried out exclusively by the student, without AI assistance:

2.1 Data Collection

All bond yield data for India and Indonesia were sourced and downloaded manually from Refinitiv Eikon. Control variables — including CBOE VIX data (FRED), sovereign CDS spreads (Investing.com), and exchange rate series (Refinitiv) — were identified, retrieved, and verified by the student. GDELT climate sentiment data was queried and extracted using the student's own pipeline. No automated AI tooling was used at any stage of data acquisition.

2.2 Research Design

The conceptual framework, including the Credibility Premium/Gap distinction, the Twin-Bond quasi-experimental design, the selection of India and Indonesia as case studies, the identification of treatment events, and the staggered Difference-in-Differences specification, was developed independently through a review of the literature and iterative discussion with the thesis supervisor.

2.3 Literature Review and Theoretical Framing

The identification, reading, synthesis, and citation of academic sources was carried out by the student. All scholarly arguments, interpretations of prior findings, and theoretical contributions are the student's own.

2.4 Empirical Interpretation and Scholarly Judgement

All conclusions drawn from regression tables, event study plots, and robustness checks — including the decision to report null findings for H1 and H3 and the directionally unexpected result for H2 — reflect the student's own academic judgement, formed in dialogue with the supervisor.

3. Areas Where AI Assistance Was Used

The following tasks were supported by LLM assistance. In all cases, the student directed the work, reviewed all outputs critically, and made independent decisions about what to retain, revise, or discard.

3.1 Code Development and Debugging

LLM assistance was used in the development and debugging of the empirical code pipeline. Specific areas of AI-supported coding include:

- Construction of the staggered DiD panel in PySpark and pandas (Databricks notebooks).
- Event study lead/lag variable generation and plotting routines.
- GDELT API query construction and V2Tone extraction scripts.
- ClimateBERT inference pipeline on Google Colab.
- Diagnostic checks including Durbin-Watson statistics, first-differencing transformations, and residual plots.
- Visualisation code for all figures appearing in Chapter 5.

All code was reviewed, tested, and validated by the student. The student retained full responsibility for methodological decisions embedded in the code, including variable construction choices, fixed effects specifications, and robustness check designs.

3.2 Writing Structure and Academic Expression

LLM assistance was used to improve the structure, clarity, and academic register of written sections. This included:

- Reorganising and tightening paragraph flow in draft chapter sections.
- Improving the precision of technical language describing the empirical methodology.
- Suggesting more formal or concise alternatives to draft phrasing, which the student then evaluated and selectively adopted.
- Checking for internal consistency of terminology across chapters.

All substantive content — arguments, evidence, interpretations, and conclusions — originates from the student. The LLM did not generate new ideas, claims, or scholarly positions; its role was limited to editing and restructuring existing student-authored material.

3.3 Results Verification and Sanity Checking

LLM assistance was used as a secondary check on the plausibility of empirical results. Specifically:

- Regression coefficient magnitudes and signs were discussed with the LLM to assess whether results were consistent with economic theory and prior literature.
- The directional interpretation of the Signaling Noise result — which ran counter to the Credibility Gap hypothesis — was reviewed in dialogue with the LLM to identify plausible economic mechanisms.
- Durbin-Watson statistics and first-differencing improvements were contextualised against standard econometric benchmarks.

- ClimateBERT correlation coefficients were cross-checked for consistency with the GDELT V2Tone baseline.

These discussions served as an independent sense-check analogous to consulting a knowledgeable peer. All final interpretations were made by the student and, where appropriate, reviewed by the thesis supervisor.

4. AI Tools Were Not Used For

- Generating any portion of the literature review, theoretical framework, or scholarly argument.
- Selecting, downloading, or cleaning source data.
- Designing the research question, empirical strategy, or case selection rationale.
- Drawing conclusions or making policy recommendations.
- Producing any figure, table, or statistical output that appears in the thesis without independent student verification.

I confirm that the above declaration is accurate and complete, and that this thesis represents my own original scholarly work.

Signature: Nahian Ibnat

Name: Nahian Ibnat

Date: April 2026